Pause Bell’s 300 MW AI Data Centre

Regina–Wascana NDP — CIA Money. MAGA Investors. Our Grid, Our Choice.

This package contains organizing assets for the community campaign to pause Bell Canada’s proposed 300 MW AI data centre campus in the RM of Sherwood, outside Regina, Saskatchewan (Treaty 4 territory). Prepared by Barrett Soron for Regina–Wascana NDP, April 2026.

Contents: petition print sheet · canvasser guide · fact sheet · tenant explainer (CoreWeave & Cerebras) · social copy · chapter email · Indigenous consultation questions

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Source repository: github.com/barrettsoron/ndp-eda-toolkit/data-centre-regina

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Pause Bell's 300 MW AI Data Centre

Regina–Wascana NDP ■ Treaty 4 territory ■ CIA Money. MAGA Investors. Our Grid, Our Choice.

NDP NPD

Bell Canada is building a 300 MW AI data centre campus in the RM of Sherwood — serving American AI firms CoreWeave and Cerebras (a US military contractor with active DARPA contracts and CIA venture funding) — with no meaningful community consultation, no environmental assessment, and no democratic oversight. Four of seven RM of Sherwood council members resigned after the announcement. We are calling on the federal government to pause the project until our community has a say.

> ***"I call on the federal government to pause the expansion of AI data centres in Canada — starting with Bell Canada's proposed 300 MW campus outside Regina — until meaningful community consultation, environmental assessment, and democratic oversight have taken place. Our energy, our water, and our data sovereignty must serve Canadians first."***

FULL NAME

STREET ADDRESS **UNIT / APARTMENT**

CITY **POSTAL CODE**

EMAIL ADDRESS

PHONE (OPTIONAL)

SIGNATURE **DATE**

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Canvasser Guide: Data Centre Petition

CIA Money. MAGA Investors. Our Grid, Our Choice.

Regina–Wascana NDP | For volunteer use
Data and sources reviewed and verified as of April 16, 2026.

The 30-second opener (door or table)

> *"Hi — I'm a volunteer with the Regina–Wascana NDP. We're collecting signatures on a petition about the Bell AI data centre being built just outside Regina. It's a massive facility — 300 megawatts — that could drive up electricity bills for everyone in the province, and it's being built to serve American AI companies. The NDP is calling for a pause on data centre expansion until communities have a real say. Can I tell you more, or would you like to sign?"*

If they seem interested, lead with whichever angle connects: energy bills, jobs, governance, or data sovereignty.

What's being built (if they ask)

Bell Canada is building what it calls Canada's largest AI data centre campus — 300 MW on 160 acres in the RM of Sherwood, just south of the city. The announced investment is $1.7 billion. The anchor tenants are CoreWeave and Cerebras — both American AI companies.

Construction is set to start this spring, with operations expected by the end of 2027. SaskEnergy is building a new high-pressure natural gas pipeline specifically to feed the facility.

The land is owned by **George Gordon First Nation**, which has signed a memorandum of understanding with Bell on Indigenous procurement and workforce development. If someone raises that, acknowledge it honestly — the partnership is real — and pivot to the concerns that apply regardless: electricity rates, who actually uses the compute and under what law, and the absence of independent environmental review.

Why it matters locally (use the angle that lands)

Energy bills: "In Virginia, where data centres have clustered, regulators say residential electricity bills could more than double by 2045 unless data centres pay their fair share — and the state just had to create a special rate class to try to protect households. Saskatchewan's grid is already strained. A 300 MW facility is a huge new load, and SaskEnergy is building a new gas pipeline just to serve it. Who do you think pays when the grid gets more expensive to run?"

Jobs: "Bell says 800 temporary construction jobs and 80 permanent ones. Eighty. For a facility that could reshape the province's energy future. That's not an economic development plan — that's a server farm."

Governance: "Four of seven RM of Sherwood council members resigned right after this was announced. The province then stepped in and appointed replacements — so the locally-elected oversight on this development was replaced with provincial appointees."

Data sovereignty: "The anchor tenants are American AI companies — CoreWeave and Cerebras. Under US law — the CLOUD Act — American authorities can compel access to data stored by US companies, even when it's physically in Canada. This isn't theoretical. When the ICC prosecutor issued an arrest warrant for Netanyahu, Trump sanctioned him and Microsoft cut off his email. Microsoft France later admitted under oath to the French Senate that it 'cannot guarantee' it would deny US government requests for data stored in Europe. That's the same legal regime these data centres operate under."

Climate: "Saskatchewan's grid runs on roughly 80–90% fossil fuels — coal and natural gas. A 300 MW data centre on this grid isn't green tech. SaskEnergy is building a new high-pressure gas pipeline just for this facility, and the province has said the baseload requirements justify refurbishing coal plants. Premier Moe has already committed to running coal until 2050. This project isn't neutral on climate — it's a reason to keep the coal burning."

Community impact: "Data centres often target locations with weak governance or oversight. Bell has been short on details and slow to respond to local concerns about noise and light pollution, local water sources, storm drainage, and disturbance to the surrounding area. They recently held a private meeting with concerned landowners who had been formally requesting information for months. There's still nothing on record or binding about the impact to the area — or what can be done if they aren't compliant."

Public infrastructure, private profit: "SaskPower, SaskEnergy, and SaskTel were built by CCF and NDP governments as public goods — Saskatchewan invented the Crown corporation. Bell already charges Canadians some of the highest phone and internet rates in the developed world, and now wants the publicly-built grid and a new publicly-funded gas pipeline to sell cheap compute to American AI firms. That's the public choice at stake: who do our utilities serve?"

Who are the tenants?

It's worth knowing who Bell is building this for.

CoreWeave started as a cryptocurrency mining company called Atlantic Crypto, founded in 2017 by three hedge fund traders. They pivoted to renting AI server capacity when the money shifted. They went public in early 2025 at a reduced price; the company is deeply unprofitable and carrying roughly $7.5 billion in debt. Major backers include Magnetar Capital — the hedge fund that famously profited from the 2008 financial crisis. About 1,000 employees manage billions in infrastructure. No published policy excluding surveillance or military AI applications from their platform.

Cerebras is an AI chip company with active, multi-phase contracts with **DARPA** — the US military's research agency — including building real-time battlefield simulation and electronic warfare systems for the US Navy. The CIA's venture capital arm, **In-Q-Tel**, is an investor. So is **1789 Capital**, the anti-ESG fund co-founded by Rebekah Mercer (major Trump donor) and linked to Peter Thiel — an explicitly "America First" fund. Cerebras's largest customer, accounting for 87% of its revenue in the first half of 2024, was G42, a UAE AI conglomerate flagged by the US Congress for ties to Chinese military and human rights abuses. Cerebras postponed its 2024 IPO after CFIUS — the US national-security review board — opened an investigation into G42's ownership stake, and withdrew the filing in October 2025. It is now refiling for a 2026 listing with G42 reportedly no longer an investor.

These are the companies Saskatchewan is being asked to build public infrastructure for.

What the NDP is calling for

NDP Leader Avi Lewis has committed to a **Humans-First AI Policy** that includes **pausing the expansion of AI data centres in Canada** — to protect clean water, preserve energy for human health and wellbeing, and give democratic institutions time to catch up to a technology that's been deployed without public debate.

Specific federal levers include:

- Amending the Canadian Environmental Protection Act to regulate data centre impacts
- Withdrawing federal dollars that fund data centre projects
- Levying a tax on data centres
- Or a combination of all of the above

This isn't anti-technology. It's a call for technology that serves people, not the other way around.

Common objections

"It's $1.7 billion in investment — that's good for Saskatchewan."

> *"The investment number sounds big, but follow the money. Most of it goes to construction (temporary) and equipment (manufactured elsewhere). Eighty permanent jobs. The energy costs and infrastructure burden stay with us permanently. Investment is only good if the community actually benefits."*

"We need the jobs."

> *"Eighty permanent jobs. Compare that to what the same public investment could create in housing, health care, or renewable energy — sectors that employ people locally, at scale, permanently. This isn't a jobs plan."*

"Data centres are the future — you can't stop progress."

> *"Nobody's saying stop all technology. The NDP supports useful applications of machine learning — things like medical research and solar tracking. What we're questioning is whether a 300 MW facility serving American AI corporations should jump the queue ahead of affordable energy, clean water, and community consent. A pause isn't a ban. It's a chance for our democratic institutions to catch up."*

"Bell says they're using a closed-loop cooling system — no water impact."

> *"That's their claim. But closed-loop systems require significantly more energy to operate than water-cooled ones. On a fossil-fuel grid, that means more emissions. And independent experts have raised questions about what 'closed-loop' actually means at this scale. The point is: we don't have independent assessment yet. That's exactly why there should be a pause."*

"These are big, reputable companies — Bell, CoreWeave, Cerebras."

> *"Bell is the landlord — but the tenants are worth looking at. CoreWeave started as a cryptocurrency mining operation run by hedge fund guys. They're carrying $7.5 billion in debt and went public at a reduced price. Cerebras has active military contracts with DARPA — the US military research agency — building battlefield simulation systems. The CIA's venture fund is an investor. So is an anti-ESG fund linked to Rebekah Mercer*

> *and Peter Thiel. These aren't community partners. They're speculative American military-tech firms looking for cheap energy."*

"The provincial government supports it."

> *"The provincial government also plans to run coal plants until 2050 — two decades past the federal phase-out deadline. Provincial support doesn't mean it's in the community's interest. That's what the petition is about: making sure the federal government uses its levers to protect communities, regardless of what the province signs off on."*

"Isn't this an Indigenous-partnered project? Who is the NDP to object?"

> *"George Gordon First Nation has signed a real partnership with Bell, and the land is GGFN-owned. That's legitimate Indigenous economic participation and we respect it. Our concerns are different: they're about electricity rates for every household in the province, who actually uses the compute and under what legal regime, the grid emissions and new pipelines SaskEnergy is building for this, and the absence of independent environmental review. None of that contradicts the GGFN partnership — it's about federal policy on the data centre industry as a whole, and about the American tenants who'll be leasing the servers."*

The ask

1. **Sign the paper petition** — collect name, address, postal code, email, and phone. All fields help, but don't push if someone hesitates on phone.
2. **Offer to leave a fact sheet** — good for people who want to think about it or share with family.
3. **Note the conversation** — if someone is particularly engaged, enthusiastic, or wants to get involved, flag them for your chapter lead. These are future volunteers.

What to do with signed petitions

- Keep pages flat and dry — don't fold.
- Return to your chapter lead or bring to the next Regina–Wascana NDP event.
- If you collect email addresses, those will be entered into the NDP database by authorized EDA personnel — **do not photograph, screenshot, or store personal data on your personal devices**.

Data custody

The Regina–Wascana NDP electoral district association has custody of all data collected through this petition, governed by the federal NDP Privacy Policy. Personal information is used to contact signatories about NDP activities, shared with riding associations as needed, and never sold. Signatories can opt out at any time by contacting dnc@ndp.ca.

If you have questions about data handling, direct them to your chapter lead.

Notes

- This is a **party** action — Regina–Wascana NDP. Keep branding at the riding association level.
- The petition asks the **federal government** to act — this is relevant federal jurisdiction (environmental regulation, federal funding, trade and commerce).
- This initiative takes place on **Treaty 4 territory**. Acknowledge this respectfully. Do not speak on behalf of First Nations — if someone raises Indigenous consultation concerns, listen, note them, and share with your chapter lead.

Regina–Wascana NDP | April 2026

Bell's AI Data Centre: What Regina Needs to Know

CIA Money. MAGA Investors. Our Grid, Our Choice.

Regina–Wascana NDP
Treaty 4 territory | Data and sources reviewed and verified as of April 16, 2026.

What's being built?

Bell Canada is constructing what it calls Canada's largest purpose-built AI data centre campus — 300 megawatts of capacity on 160 acres in the Rural Municipality of Sherwood, just south of Regina. The announced investment is $1.7 billion, with Bell projecting $12 billion in economic value over time.

The anchor tenants are **CoreWeave** and **Cerebras** — both American artificial intelligence companies. Construction is set to begin spring 2026, with first operations expected by the end of 2027.

The site sits on land held by **George Gordon First Nation**, which has signed a memorandum of understanding with Bell focused on Indigenous procurement and workforce development. The concerns raised in this fact sheet — electricity costs, environmental review, grid emissions, and US data sovereignty — are questions of federal policy on the data centre industry. They apply regardless of the land arrangement, and they're not a comment on GGFN's decision to participate.

Who are CoreWeave and Cerebras?

CoreWeave was founded in 2017 as Atlantic Crypto — a cryptocurrency mining operation run by three hedge fund traders who pivoted to renting AI server capacity. The company went public in March 2025 at a reduced offering price. It is deeply unprofitable, carrying roughly $7.5 billion in debt backed by Nvidia GPU contracts — a financing package co-led by Blackstone and Magnetar Capital (the hedge fund famous for profiting from the 2008 financial crisis). CoreWeave employs roughly 1,000–1,500 people to manage billions in infrastructure — a capital-intensive model that creates very few local jobs. The company has no published policy excluding surveillance or military AI applications from its platform.

Cerebras makes AI processors and has **active contracts with DARPA** — the US military's advanced research agency. It is currently building real-time battlefield simulation and electronic warfare systems for the US Navy. The CIA's venture capital arm, **In-Q-Tel**, is an investor, describing Cerebras as part of its effort to "scale trustworthy, U.S.-based AI infrastructure for national security applications." In its $1.1-billion Series G funding round, Cerebras added **1789 Capital** — an anti-ESG fund co-founded by Rebekah Mercer (a major Trump donor) and linked to Peter Thiel. The fund explicitly aims to build an "America First" parallel economy. Cerebras's largest customer, accounting for **87% of its revenue** in the first half of 2024, was G42, a UAE AI conglomerate that the US House Select Committee on China flagged for ties to Chinese military-civil fusion and human rights abuses. Cerebras postponed its 2024 IPO after the US government (CFIUS) opened a national-security review of G42's ownership stake, and withdrew the filing in October 2025. It is refiling now, targeting a 2026 listing — with G42 reportedly no longer listed as an investor.

These are the companies that Saskatchewan is being asked to reshape its energy grid and public infrastructure for.

What are the concerns?

Energy costs for everyone. A 300 MW facility is an enormous new load on Saskatchewan's grid. In Virginia — where data centres have clustered at industrial scale — regulators project residential electricity bills could more than double by 2045 unless data centres pay their share of grid costs. Dominion has already been granted rate increases, and the state has created a dedicated large-load rate class to try to shield households from further cost exposure. SaskEnergy is building a new high-pressure natural gas pipeline specifically to feed this facility. Infrastructure costs don't stay at the data centre — they get spread across every ratepayer in the province.

Eighty permanent jobs. Bell projects 800 temporary construction jobs and 80 permanent positions. For a facility of this scale, that's minimal local employment. The $12 billion headline masks the fact that most of the economic activity flows to equipment manufacturers and the American AI companies leasing server space — not to Saskatchewan workers and families.

A fossil-fuel anchor. Saskatchewan's grid runs on roughly 80–90% fossil fuels (the mix is currently shifting toward more natural gas and less coal). At 630 g CO_2e per kilowatt-hour, its emission intensity is more than six times the national average of 100 g. A 300 MW data centre on this grid isn't green technology — it's a massive new source of carbon emissions that locks the province into fossil-fuel dependence for decades. And that's not abstract: SaskEnergy is building a new high-pressure gas pipeline and meter station dedicated to Bell's on-site gas generation, and the province has said the data centre's baseload needs justify refurbishing aging coal plants. Premier Moe has already committed to running coal until 2050 — twenty years past the federal phase-out deadline. This project makes that timeline harder to undo.

Governance breakdown. Four of seven RM of Sherwood council members resigned shortly after the data centre was announced. The province then appointed interim replacements — meaning locally-elected oversight was replaced with provincial appointees at the very moment major decisions about the development were still being made.

Canadian data in American hands. CoreWeave and Cerebras are US-incorporated companies. Under American law — including the CLOUD Act — US authorities can compel access to data held by American companies regardless of where the data is physically stored.

This is not theoretical. In 2025, President Trump sanctioned the International Criminal Court's chief prosecutor and Microsoft cut off his email access. When the French Senate asked Microsoft France under oath whether it could guarantee it would deny US government requests for data stored on its servers within the European Union, the company said it "cannot guarantee" that. As journalist Paris Marx has argued, every data centre operated by a US company is effectively an extension of US jurisdiction — what European lawmakers have called a digital "kill switch." The Canada-United States-Mexico Agreement makes this worse: it contains clauses that limit Canada's ability to regulate cross-border data flows or require companies to store Canadian data within our borders.

What about water?

Bell claims the facility will use a closed-loop cooling system that doesn't draw municipal water. However, closed-loop systems require significantly more energy than water-cooled alternatives. On a fossil-fuel grid, that energy cost translates directly to more emissions. Independent experts have raised questions about what "closed-loop" actually means at industrial scale, and no independent environmental assessment has been conducted.

For context: globally, data centre water consumption is projected to rise from 560 billion litres per year to 1,200 billion litres by 2030, according to the International Energy Agency. A single Microsoft data centre in Vaughan, Ontario is expected to consume 730 million litres annually.

What is the NDP calling for?

NDP Leader Avi Lewis has committed to a **Humans-First AI Policy** that includes **pausing the expansion of AI data centres in Canada** — to protect clean water, preserve energy for human health and wellbeing, and give our democratic institutions time to catch up to a technology that has been deployed without any public debate. This is a federal ask because the underlying questions — national security, data sovereignty, cross-border data flows, and who owns Canadian AI infrastructure — are federal in nature. The Regina project is the proximate trigger. The concern is national.

Specific federal tools include amending the Canadian Environmental Protection Act to regulate data centre environmental impacts, withdrawing federal funding for data centre projects, and levying a tax on data centres.

The NDP draws a clear line between small-scale, publicly useful machine learning — like medical research — and the multi-billion-dollar corporate AI industry built on generative AI, mass data extraction, and the displacement of millions of workers.

Who benefits? Who pays?

The $1.7 billion investment benefits Bell Canada, CoreWeave, and Cerebras. The energy costs, infrastructure burden, emissions, and governance fallout stay with Saskatchewan families and communities.

Bell already charges Canadians some of the highest phone and internet rates in the developed world. Now the same company wants the publicly-built SaskPower grid and a new publicly-funded SaskEnergy gas pipeline to sell cheap compute to American AI firms. SaskPower, SaskEnergy, and SaskTel were built by CCF and NDP governments as public goods — Saskatchewan invented the Crown corporation on the principle that energy, telecommunications, and other essentials must serve people first. That tradition is exactly what this project asks us to trade away.

This petition asks the federal government to use every lever it has to ensure data centre development serves the public interest — not corporate shareholders.

Sign the petition

Talk to your local Regina–Wascana NDP volunteer, or contact the riding association to get involved.

Who Are CoreWeave and Cerebras?

CIA Money. MAGA Investors. Our Grid, Our Choice.

Regina–Wascana NDP
Background on the anchor tenants of Bell's proposed AI data centre in the RM of Sherwood.

Bell Canada is building the facility. But the companies that will actually occupy it — the reason it exists — are **CoreWeave** and **Cerebras**, both American.

CoreWeave: From Crypto Mining to AI Servers

CoreWeave was founded in 2017 as **Atlantic Crypto** by Michael Intrator, Brian Venturo, and Brannin McBee — three hedge fund traders who ran an Ethereum cryptocurrency mining operation. When the crypto market shifted, they pivoted the same GPU hardware to renting AI server capacity. The company rebranded to CoreWeave in 2019.

Financial profile: CoreWeave went public on the NASDAQ in March 2025. The IPO was troubled — they had to reduce both the offering price and size. The company is deeply unprofitable, carrying roughly **$7.5 billion in debt**, much of it collateralized against their Nvidia GPU contracts. A single customer — Microsoft — reportedly accounted for more than 60% of their revenue at the time of the IPO. If AI demand softens, the debt structure becomes precarious.

Major investors: The company's $7.5 billion debt facility was co-led by **Blackstone** and **Magnetar Capital** — the hedge fund that became infamous for profiting from the 2008 financial crisis by betting against mortgage-backed securities it helped create. Other investors include Coatue Management, Jane Street, and Nvidia itself (which is both their supplier and an investor — a vertical entanglement that raises competition questions).

Workforce: Roughly 1,000–1,500 employees manage billions in infrastructure. This is a capital-intensive model that creates very few local jobs — consistent with the 80 permanent positions Bell is projecting for the Saskatchewan facility.

Acceptable use: CoreWeave has **no published policy** excluding surveillance, facial recognition, predictive policing, or military AI applications from its platform. Their business model is infrastructure-agnostic — they rent GPU capacity to any paying customer.

US law exposure: As a US-incorporated company, CoreWeave is subject to the **CLOUD Act**, which allows American law enforcement and intelligence agencies to compel access to data stored on their servers — regardless of where those servers are physically located. Data stored on CoreWeave infrastructure in Saskatchewan could be accessed by US authorities without Canadian judicial oversight.

Cerebras: AI Chips for the Pentagon

Cerebras Systems builds wafer-scale AI processors — massive chips designed to train and run AI models. Their hardware is among the most powerful AI processors in the world. But the question isn't what the chips can do. It's who they're for.

US military contracts: Cerebras has **active, multi-phase contracts with DARPA** — the US Department of Defense's advanced research agency. It is currently in Phase 3 of the **Digital RF Battlespace Emulator** program, building real-time battlefield simulation and electronic warfare systems for the **US Navy**. In April 2025, DARPA selected Cerebras for an additional contract to deliver a "next generation, real-time compute platform for advanced military and commercial applications," with capabilities including real-time AI processing from military sensors and battlefield robotics.

CIA funding: Cerebras is a portfolio company of **In-Q-Tel** — the CIA's venture capital arm. In-Q-Tel describes Cerebras as "a cornerstone of In-Q-Tel's efforts to scale trustworthy, U.S.-based AI infrastructure for national security applications."

Trump-linked investor: In its $1.1-billion Series G funding round, Cerebras added **1789 Capital** as an investor. 1789 Capital is an anti-ESG venture fund co-founded by **Rebekah Mercer** — one of the largest donors to Donald Trump's political campaigns — with **Peter Thiel** instrumental in its creation. The fund explicitly aims to build an "America First" parallel economy.

UAE and Chinese military ties: Cerebras's largest customer, accounting for **87% of its revenue** in the first half of 2024, was **G42** — a UAE-based AI conglomerate. The US House Select Committee on China flagged G42's CEO for affiliations with "companies that develop dual-use technologies and materially support PRC military-civil fusion and human rights abuses." G42 had business ties to Huawei and BGI Genomics (a Chinese genomics firm placed on the US Entity List over surveillance concerns). Under pressure from the Committee on Foreign Investment in the United States (CFIUS), G42 was forced to divest from Chinese companies, and its Cerebras stake was restructured to non-voting shares.

Postponed and withdrawn IPO: Cerebras filed for a public offering in 2024 but **postponed and then withdrew it in October 2025** amid the CFIUS national-security review of G42's ownership stake. The company raised $1 billion privately and has refiled — targeting a 2026 listing, with G42 reportedly no longer listed as an investor.

Every data centre is US jurisdiction

Both CoreWeave and Cerebras are subject to the **US CLOUD Act**, which compels American companies to hand over data to US authorities regardless of where it is physically stored. Data on servers in Saskatchewan is legally accessible to US intelligence and law enforcement without Canadian judicial oversight.

This is not an abstract legal concern. In 2025, when the International Criminal Court's chief prosecutor issued an arrest warrant for Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu, President Trump sanctioned the prosecutor and **Microsoft cut off his email access**. When the French Senate subsequently asked Microsoft France under oath whether it could deny US government requests for data stored within the European Union, the company admitted it **"cannot guarantee"** that.

As journalist Paris Marx has argued, every data centre operated by a US company functions as an extension of US jurisdiction — what European lawmakers now call a digital "kill switch." The Canada-United States-Mexico

Agreement compounds this: it contains clauses that **limit Canada's ability to regulate cross-border data flows** or to require companies to store Canadian data within our borders.

Building a 300 MW facility for US military-intelligence-linked AI companies on Canadian soil isn't just an energy question or a jobs question. It is a sovereignty question.

What this means for Saskatchewan

The $1.7-billion headline is Bell's number. But the facility is being built to serve these two companies — a debt-laden former cryptocurrency operation and a Pentagon AI contractor funded by the CIA and Trump-linked capital.

Saskatchewan is being asked to build a new natural gas pipeline, strain its electrical grid, and reshape public infrastructure for companies whose primary obligations are to American shareholders, American military agencies, and American law.

Eighty permanent jobs.

Sources

- CoreWeave origins as Atlantic Crypto: Business reporting, 2017–2019
- CoreWeave IPO and debt: Financial reporting, March 2025
- Magnetar Capital role in 2008 crisis: Widely reported (ProPublica, others)
- Cerebras DARPA contracts: Cerebras press release, Military Embedded Systems
- In-Q-Tel investment: Dakota
- 1789 Capital / Mercer / Thiel: BNN Bloomberg
- G42 revenue dependency and US Congressional concerns: The Register, House Select Committee on China
- CLOUD Act (US law): 18 U.S.C. § 2713; Clarifying Lawful Overseas Use of Data Act, 2018
- ICC prosecutor / Microsoft email cutoff: AP News
- Microsoft France Senate testimony ("cannot guarantee"): Cyber in Context
- CUSMA constraints on Canadian tech regulation: CCPA
- Paris Marx, "Every Data Centre Is a US Military Base": The Tyee

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Regina–Wascana NDP | April 2026

Social Copy: Data Centre Petition

"CIA Money. MAGA Investors. Our Grid, Our Choice."

Regina–Wascana NDP | EDA social accounts

Use or adapt freely. Tag @NDP if you want — not required.

Short (Twitter / X — under 280 characters)

Option A — energy bills:
Bell is building a 300 MW AI data centre outside Regina to serve American companies. Virginia regulators warn residential bills could more than double by 2045 without strict cost protections. We're collecting signatures to demand a pause. Our energy should serve people first.

Option B — jobs:
$1.7 billion investment. 80 permanent jobs. Bell's AI data centre near Regina is being built for American AI companies — not for Saskatchewan workers. The NDP is calling for a pause. We're collecting signatures locally.

Option C — governance:
Four of seven RM of Sherwood council members resigned after Bell's data centre announcement — and the province stepped in to appoint replacements. Locally-elected oversight on a major infrastructure decision is now in the hands of provincial appointees. We're petitioning for a federal pause until communities have a real say.

Option D — climate:
Saskatchewan's grid runs on 80% fossil fuels. A 300 MW AI data centre on that grid isn't green tech — it's a carbon anchor. The NDP leader has committed to pausing data centre expansion. We're collecting signatures in Regina–Wascana.

Option E — who are the tenants:
Bell's AI data centre near Regina is being built for CoreWeave — a former crypto mining company — and Cerebras, which has active DARPA military contracts and CIA venture funding. Rebekah Mercer's "America First" fund is an investor. This is who Saskatchewan is reshaping its grid for.

Medium (Facebook / Instagram — 100–200 words)

Option A — who benefits:

Bell Canada is building a $1.7-billion AI data centre campus on 160 acres just outside Regina. The anchor tenants? CoreWeave and Cerebras — both American AI companies.

Here's what Regina gets: 80 permanent jobs. A new natural gas pipeline. A 300 MW energy load on a grid that already runs on 80% fossil fuels. And a governance gap — four of seven RM of Sherwood council members resigned shortly after the announcement, and the province stepped in to appoint replacements.

Here's what the American AI companies get: cheap Canadian energy and land for their servers.

NDP Leader Avi Lewis has committed to pausing data centre expansion until communities have been properly consulted and environmental impacts independently assessed. Our clean water and affordable energy should serve people first — not corporate AI.

We're collecting petition signatures in Regina–Wascana. Talk to a volunteer or message us to get involved.

Option B — the Virginia warning:

In northern Virginia, where data centres have clustered at industrial scale, regulators project residential electricity bills could more than double by 2045 unless data centres pay their share of grid costs. The state has already had to create a special rate class to try to shield households from further cost exposure.

Now Bell Canada wants to build a 300 MW AI data centre just outside Regina, on Saskatchewan's coal- and gas-heavy grid. SaskEnergy is already building a new high-pressure natural gas pipeline to feed the facility. Eighty permanent jobs. American AI tenants.

The NDP is calling for a federal pause on data centre expansion — to protect affordable energy, clean water, and community decision-making. We're collecting signatures locally.

Message us to sign or volunteer.

Longer (Facebook page post — 300–400 words)

Title: "A $1.7-billion investment that leaves us holding the bill"

Bell Canada is building Canada's largest purpose-built AI data centre campus on 160 acres in the RM of Sherwood, just south of Regina. The investment: $1.7 billion. The tenants: CoreWeave and Cerebras — two American AI companies. The permanent jobs: 80.

Let's be honest about what this means for Saskatchewan.

Our electrical grid runs on roughly 80% fossil fuels — coal and natural gas. At 630 grams of CO_2e per kilowatt-hour, Saskatchewan has one of the dirtiest grids in Canada. A 300 MW data centre on this grid isn't a step toward clean energy. It's a carbon anchor that locks us into fossil fuel dependence for decades.

SaskEnergy is already building a new high-pressure natural gas pipeline specifically to serve the facility. In Virginia, where data centres have clustered at industrial scale, regulators warn residential bills could more than double by 2045 without strict cost protections — and the state has already created a dedicated rate class to try to shield households. Saskatchewan families and businesses will bear the cost of the infrastructure this facility demands.

The governance process hasn't inspired confidence either. Four of seven RM of Sherwood council members resigned shortly after the announcement, and the province appointed interim replacements — meaning locally-elected oversight on a major infrastructure decision was replaced with provincial appointees.

And then there's data sovereignty. CoreWeave and Cerebras are US-incorporated companies. Under the American CLOUD Act, US authorities can compel access to data held by American companies — regardless of where it's physically stored. We're building critical AI infrastructure on Canadian soil for companies that answer to American law.

NDP Leader Avi Lewis has committed to a Humans-First AI Policy that includes **pausing the expansion of AI data centres in Canada** — to protect clean water, preserve affordable energy for human health and wellbeing,

and give our democratic institutions time to catch up. The NDP supports useful applications of technology like medical research and clean energy management. What we're questioning is whether a 300 MW facility serving a former crypto mining company and a US military AI contractor should jump the queue ahead of community consent.

Bell already charges Canadians some of the highest phone and internet rates in the developed world. Now the same company wants our publicly-built SaskPower grid and a new publicly-funded SaskEnergy gas pipeline to sell cheap compute to American AI firms. SaskPower, SaskEnergy, and SaskTel were built by CCF and NDP governments as public goods — Saskatchewan invented the Crown corporation on the principle that some things must serve people first. And it's the same story across the economy: Loblaw posts record profits while families skip meals; Bell and Rogers charge some of the highest rates in the OECD; Cameco and Nutrien ship Saskatchewan's minerals to shareholders while communities absorb the cost. A public option — public grocery, real public telecom, public mineral royalties — is how working people claw back. A public grid that serves Saskatchewan families first, not American AI, is where we start.

We're collecting petition signatures in Regina–Wascana. If you think our energy, our water, and our democratic process should come first, add your name.

Message us or talk to a volunteer at your next local NDP event.

— Regina–Wascana NDP

Image / alt text suggestion

If using an image: Photo of the RM of Sherwood landscape or Regina skyline. Alt text: "View of the Regina area. Text overlay: '$1.7 billion for American AI. 80 jobs for Saskatchewan. Our energy should serve people first. Regina–Wascana NDP'"

Regina–Wascana NDP | April 2026

Email: Data Centre Petition Asset Package — To Members

From: Regina–Wascana NDP
To: EDA members / chapter leads
Subject: Pause Bell's 300 MW AI data centre — the petition drive

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Hi [Name],

You may have seen the news: Bell Canada is building what it calls Canada's largest AI data centre campus — 300 megawatts on 160 acres in the RM of Sherwood, just south of Regina. The announced investment is $1.7 billion. The anchor tenants are CoreWeave and Cerebras — both American AI companies.

The land is held by George Gordon First Nation, which has signed a partnership with Bell on Indigenous procurement and workforce development. Our concerns — electricity rates, US tenants and the legal regime they operate under, the grid and pipeline build-out, and the absence of independent environmental review — apply regardless of that partnership. They're questions of federal policy on the data centre industry.

Here's what that means in plain terms.

Eighty permanent jobs. Not eight hundred — that's the temporary construction figure. The permanent workforce is 80 people. For context, a single medium-sized grocery store employs more people than that.

A massive new load on our grid. Saskatchewan's electricity comes from roughly 80% fossil fuels. SaskEnergy is already building a new high-pressure natural gas pipeline specifically to serve this facility. In Virginia, where data centres have clustered at industrial scale, regulators project residential bills could more than double by 2045 without strict cost protections — and the state has already created a special rate class to try to shield households. Every ratepayer in Saskatchewan is exposed to that risk.

A governance gap. Four of seven RM of Sherwood council members resigned shortly after the announcement. The province appointed interim replacements — so locally-elected oversight on a major infrastructure decision is now in the hands of provincial appointees at exactly the moment it matters most.

American tenants, Canadian soil. Under US law, American authorities can compel access to data held by US companies regardless of where it's stored. And these aren't neutral tech firms. CoreWeave started as a cryptocurrency mining company run by hedge fund traders. Cerebras has active DARPA military contracts building battlefield simulation systems for the US Navy, CIA venture funding, and an investor roster that includes Rebekah Mercer's "America First" fund. These are the companies we're reshaping Saskatchewan's grid for.

Public infrastructure, private profit. Bell already charges Canadians some of the highest phone and internet rates in the developed world. Now they want our publicly-built grid and a new publicly-funded gas pipeline to sell cheap compute to American AI firms. SaskPower, SaskEnergy, and SaskTel were built by CCF and NDP governments as public goods — a public grid, a public gas utility, public telecom. Saskatchewan invented the Crown corporation for exactly this reason: some things must serve people first. The question in front of us is whether that tradition still means something.

NDP Leader Avi Lewis has committed to a **Humans-First AI Policy** that includes **pausing data centre expansion** until communities have been properly consulted and environmental impacts independently assessed. Our clean water and affordable energy should serve people first.

What we're doing locally:

We're collecting petition signatures across Regina–Wascana calling on the federal government to pause data centre expansion until democratic oversight catches up. This is a community-rooted initiative — your riding association, your neighbours, your signatures.

How you can help:

- **Sign the petition** at your next local NDP event or contact us to arrange pickup of signature sheets.
- **Canvass your neighbourhood** — we have a canvasser guide with talking points, common objections, and instructions. No experience needed.
- **Share on social media** — we have ready-to-post copy for Twitter/X, Facebook, and Instagram. Just ask.
- **Talk to your neighbours** — the fact sheet is a good leave-behind for anyone who wants to learn more.

If you'd like canvassing materials, signature sheets, or social copy, reply to this email and we'll get you set up.

This is one of those issues where the numbers tell the story: $1.7 billion for Bell and two American AI companies. Eighty jobs and a gas pipeline for us. That's not a fair deal — and the petition is how we say so on the record.

It's also the same story playing out across the economy. Loblaw posts record profits while families skip meals. Bell and Rogers charge some of the highest rates in the OECD. Cameco and Nutrien ship Saskatchewan's minerals to shareholders while communities absorb the cost. A public option — public grocery, real public telecom, public mineral royalties — is how working people claw back. A public grid that serves Saskatchewan families first, not American AI, is where we start.

Thanks for everything you do,

[Name]
Regina–Wascana NDP

Treaty 4 territory | April 2026

Questions for Local First Nations Contacts

For the local EDA organizer
These are conversation-starters, not a checklist. The goal is to listen and learn, not to extract endorsements.

Context

The Bell AI data centre campus is being built on 160 acres in the RM of Sherwood — Treaty 4 territory. George Gordon First Nation has signed a procurement and workforce development partnership with Bell, but at least one band member has publicly raised concerns about inadequate prior consultation before that deal was announced.

These questions are for the organizer to bring to local First Nations contacts — elders, council members, community organizers, or anyone the organizer already has a relationship with. The purpose is to understand whether and how First Nations want to engage with this issue, not to assume they should.

Conversation-starters

On the development itself:

- Has your Nation or community been consulted about the Bell data centre project? If so, what did that process look like — and did it feel adequate?
- Are there concerns in your community about the data centre's impact on water, land, or energy in the region?
- Were there conditions or commitments made to your Nation as part of the development process? If so, are you comfortable sharing what those are?

On water and land:

- Are there water sources, waterways, or lands in the area of the RM of Sherwood development that hold particular significance for your Nation?
- Has anyone in your community raised concerns about the data centre's potential effects on local water quality or supply — even if Bell claims a closed-loop cooling system?
- Are there existing environmental monitoring processes that your Nation leads or participates in that could be relevant here?

On the partnership with Bell:

- George Gordon First Nation signed a partnership with Bell focused on procurement and workforce development. Does your Nation or community have a view on that agreement — positive, critical, or otherwise?
- Are there other Nations or communities in the Treaty 4 area that haven't been part of the conversation but should have been?

On the petition and NDP organizing:

- Would your Nation or community want to be named or referenced in petition materials about this issue? Or would you prefer not to be associated with party-political materials?
- Is there existing Indigenous-led opposition to or organizing around this data centre that we should know about — and if so, how can we support it rather than duplicate it?
- Is there a better way for the NDP riding association to be a good ally on this issue than a petition? Is there something else you'd want from us?

On what would actually help:

- If you could ask the federal government for one thing regarding this data centre, what would it be?
- Is there anything about how settler organizations typically approach these conversations that you'd want us to do differently?

Notes for the organizer

- **Don't bring all of these at once.** Pick the ones that feel right for the relationship and the context. A coffee conversation with two or three questions is more valuable than a formal questionnaire.
- **Listen more than you talk.** If someone wants to tell you their perspective at length, that's the most useful thing that can happen.
- **Don't promise anything.** You're here to learn, not to negotiate. If someone asks what the NDP can do, be honest about what's in your power and what isn't.
- **Report back what you're comfortable sharing.** Some of what you hear may be shared in confidence. Use your judgement about what to pass along and what to hold.
- **If someone says "no thanks"** — to the conversation, to being named, to the petition — respect that fully and don't push.

Regina–Wascana NDP | April 2026